

6-Week Countdown to Aug 1 — who does what

Owner key: **J** = Jay (owner actions — sign, pay, in-person, hire) · **C** = Candelo (systems, tracking, drafting, the back office) · **C+J** = shared (Candelo preps, Jay executes/decides) · **V** = vendor/contractor (Jay engages, Candelo tracks).

The regulatory/opening track is Jay's (his plan nailed it); the **operating track is Candelo's** — and the two run in parallel so the Control Room is live *the day the doors open*. Confirmed: zoning (by-right, no CUP), scope (cosmetics-only production; food = sealed resale), raw-dairy resale (no extra license). The single regulatory long pole is the county market permit — **pre-filled and ready to fax (Doc H)**.

WEEK 1 · Jun 22–28 (now) — file the long pole + power up the building

OWNER	ACTION
C+J	Fax the Stanislaus County market permit (Doc H pre-fill: New Business / Market / 2,001–6,000 sq ft / 0–20 seating / within city limits = Yes) → fax 209-525-6774 . Call DER first (209-525-6700): plan-review vs straight-to-inspection + fee.
C+J	Start the filing order (Appendix B): EIN (if new entity) → CDTFA seller's permit (free, online) → DBA "Frontier Organics – Local Natural Provisions" (County Clerk, ~\$40) → City of Modesto business license . Candelo pre-fills each; Jay signs/submits.
J	Order internet Day 1 — AT&T Business Fiber (check 429 McHenry) or Comcast Xfinity Business; add 5G failover for POS. (Installs take 1–2+ weeks — order first.)
J / V	Utilities into business name (PG&E, City water/sewer, trash); new security system w/ a NEW company (baseline RAND \$220/qtr); decide cleaning crew vs DIY (lean crew given timeline).
C	Stand up the Control Room on Frontier's Google Workspace; load the readiness board with every row below, dated to Aug 1.
C+J	Decision call: lock POS = Square + the inventory call (Control Room vs Craftybase — Candelo demos the production module live).

WEEK 2 · Jun 29–Jul 5 — licenses in flight + the store starts taking shape

OWNER	ACTION
C+J	FDA / MoCRA registration + product listing (Frontier Organics, Tallips, TALO) — Candelo drafts; note the small-business exemption + eye/oral carve-outs (RESEARCH_FACTS B).
J	Bind insurance — general liability, product liability (critical: skincare + raw dairy), property/ contents, workers' comp. Candelo has the broker message ready.
J / V	Begin fixtures — metal shelving, cabinets, displays; confirm Modesto sign permit + front signage (local sign co. or Neil).
C	Build the pricing & margin sheet per category (house brands / food / goods) — keystone-on-keystone floor, target COGS ≤30% (RESEARCH_FACTS C).
C	Stand up cold-chain temp-logging + receiving workflows for the freezers (beef, dairy, eggs).
J	Publish the DBA newspaper notice (4 weekly runs — start now so it clears before/around opening).

WEEK 3 · Jul 6–12 — compliance spine + vendor onboarding

OWNER	ACTION
C+J	Food handler cards for Jay + any staff (online, ~\$15 each).
C	Claim/labeling review — run every house product through the green/yellow/red tracker; no high-risk claim becomes shelf signage/POS copy until reviewed (RESEARCH_FACTS B per-product verdicts).
C+J	Vendor & sourcing compliance — signed vendor/consignment agreements (honey, candles, eggs, woodwork); collect COAs; verify each food vendor's permits ; resale certificates.
C+J	Raw-dairy : get WRITTEN proof the farm holds a current CDFA Market Milk Permit + bottling licensing ; confirm sealed-only handling. Candelo tracks as a vendor-qualification row.
J / V	Buy stainless work tables + ingredient storage to fill out the melt/mix/fill area (production equipment already in place).

WEEK 4 · Jul 13–19 — inventory loaded + POS configured

OWNER	ACTION
C	Barcode / label system for house SKUs + vendor goods; SKU cleanup (<code>sku_ready</code> / <code>do_not_sell_until_identified</code>).
C+J	Configure Square (register + markets) and connect the Control Room sales feed; decide Shopify-online keep-vs-consolidate (defer migration to post-soft-open).
C	Load the production module — recipes, materials w/ lot+cost, first batches → released finished goods → inventory by location.
J / V	Confirm Certificate of Occupancy covers retail + accessory production; verify electrical/plumbing sound; ADA + handwash sink per any plan check.
J	Hire / schedule staff; assign roles (register, restocking, production room).

WEEK 5 · Jul 20–26 — stock, inspect, dry-run the systems

OWNER	ACTION
J / V	Pass DER pre-opening inspection → permit issues (CA Retail Food Code §114381). Schedule early in the week to leave buffer.
J / V	First freezer stock-up with dairy/meat supplier (set the weekly cadence); stock house brands + vendor goods; set planogram.
C	Daily closeout + dashboard dry-run with real-ish data; reorder points set; returns/recall procedure documented.
C+J	Cash handling + opening float ; confirm complaint/adverse-event log + same-day escalation flags.
C	Launch presence — Google Business Profile + Apple Maps; tie store IG/TikTok to the existing audience.

WEEK 6 · Jul 27–Aug 1 — soft open, fix, grand open

DATE	OWNER	ACTION
Jul 27–28 (Mon–Tue)	C+J	Final readiness go/no-go: every readiness row green; permit in hand; insurance bound; POS + Control Room live.
Jul 29–30 (Wed–Thu)	C+J	SOFT OPEN — dial in flow, POS, staffing, and the daily closeout on live transactions. Candelo runs the back office in real time; fix what the soft open exposes.
Jul 31 (Fri)	C+J	Restock from soft-open learnings; final temp-log + cash-float check; grand-opening promo staged.
Aug 1 (Sat)	J + C	GRAND OPEN. Jay runs the floor; Candelo runs the operation — live inventory/COGS, cold-chain logs, daily "what to make/restock/fix/stop," reporting from day one. Cross-promote at Central Valley farmers markets.

The critical path (don't let these slip)

1. **Market permit fax** → **DER response** → **inspection** (Week 1 → Week 5). The longest pole — started Day 1.
2. **Internet install** (order Week 1; 1–2+ weeks) — 5G failover is the safety net for POS on opening day.
3. **Insurance bound before any sale** (Week 2) — product liability is non-negotiable for consumables + raw dairy.
4. **DBA newspaper publication** (starts Week 2; 4 weekly runs) — start early so it clears.
5. **Inspection pass** (Week 5) — leaves a one-week buffer before soft open.

What's Candelo's vs Jay's, in one line

Jay opens it — lease, build-out, permits, inspections, insurance, hiring, the storefront. **Candelo runs it** — the Control Room and everything that operates the store after Aug 1: inventory, COGS, cold-chain logs, claims/MoCRA, complaints/recall, reorder, daily close, reporting, dashboards.

Dates are calendar-anchored to Jay's plan. Confirm fees, inspection slots, and install windows directly with each agency/vendor — those set the real critical path.